

## Ideation Phase

### Empathize & Discover

|              |                                                |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Team ID      | SWTID-2026-1448                                |
| Project Name | Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) |

#### Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes.

It is a useful tool to help teams better understand their users.

Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person who is experiencing it. The exercise of creating the map helps participants consider things from the user's perspective along with his or her goals and challenges.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas>

#### Empathy Map: Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

##### User / Persona

ServiceNow Administrator (HR data admin) who receives bulk employee data in Excel for onboarding and updates, and must load it into ServiceNow accurately without duplicates.

##### Think & Feel

*What does the user think and feel?*

- "Will this data land correctly the first time?"
- Worried about duplicate or wrong employee records
- Under pressure to onboard new joiners on time
- Wants a repeatable process that is not error-prone

##### Hear

*What does the user hear?*

- Manager: "New joiners' records are needed by Monday."
- HR: "The spreadsheet is updated again – please refresh ServiceNow."
- Colleagues: "Manual entry always leads to typos."
- Trainers / community: "Use Import Sets and Transform Maps for bulk loads."

##### See

*What does the user see?*

- Excel sheets with dozens or hundreds of employee rows
- The same Employee ID in different files with changed names or emails
- Records typed one by one into ServiceNow forms
- Import logs showing inserts, updates and errors

##### Say & Do

*What does the user say and do?*

- Says: "Can we automate this instead of typing each record?"
- Copies rows and cross-checks them against Excel
- Re-uploads corrected files and checks Transform History
- Builds reports to show HR the final numbers

## Pain

*Fears, frustrations, obstacles*

- Slow, repetitive manual data entry
- Duplicate records when the same file is imported twice
- Typos and inconsistent names, emails and departments
- Hard to prove what was inserted and what was updated
- No quick view of employees by department or location

## Gain

*Wants, needs, measures of success*

- Whole spreadsheet loaded in one go through an Import Set
- Field mapping done once in a reusable Transform Map
- Coalesce on Employee ID updates records instead of duplicating
- Transform History confirms inserts, updates and ignored rows
- Dashboard gives HR live visibility of employee data

**Key insight:** The administrator needs a repeatable, duplicate-safe way to bring spreadsheet data into ServiceNow and to see the results clearly. This leads to the solution: Import Set (staging) + Transform Map (field mapping) + Coalesce on Employee ID + Reports and a Dashboard.